

Rule 3: Iqlab — Conversion

RULE: When Noon Sakinah or Tanween is followed by BA, the Noon is converted into a HIDDEN MEEM sound, held with ghunnah (2 beats).

Only 1 Letter — Ba

Iqlab applies to ONE letter only: Ba (b). This is the EASIEST rule to identify.

Why Does This Happen?

The Noon comes from the tongue. Immediately after, the Ba requires BOTH LIPS to close. Moving from tongue (Noon) straight to lips (Ba) is physically awkward. By converting the Noon to Meem (also a lip letter), the transition becomes smooth and natural.

Noon (tongue) → Ba (lips) = awkward jump

Noon → Hidden Meem (lips) → Ba (lips) = smooth transition

How to Perform Iqlab

- Step 1: See Noon Sakinah or Tanween followed by Ba
- Step 2: Do NOT pronounce the Noon as a clear 'n' sound
- Step 3: Close your lips (as if saying Meem)
- Step 4: Hold the nasal (ghunnah) sound for 2 beats
- Step 5: Release naturally into the Ba

Visual Cue in the Mushaf

In the printed Quran (mushaf), a small Meem is written above the Noon or Tanween whenever Iqlab applies. This is your visual reminder to convert the Noon to hidden Meem.

Quranic Examples

Arabic/Phrase	Pronunciation	Note
Min Ba'd	mim-ba'd	After — small Meem visible above Noon
Anbiyaa	ambiyaa	Prophets — Noon before Ba in same word
Tanbin (tanween + Ba)	With meem conversion	Indefinite noun + Ba = Iqlab on tanween
Min Ba'dihim	mim-ba'dihim	From after them — common Quranic phrase

Summary

- ★ Only 1 letter causes Iqlab — Ba. Makes it the easiest rule.
- ★ Look for the small Meem printed in the mushaf above Noon/Tanween before Ba.
- ★ Total covered: 6 (Izhar) + 6 (Idgham) + 1 (Iqlab) = 13. Remaining: 15 letters → Ikhfa.